

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

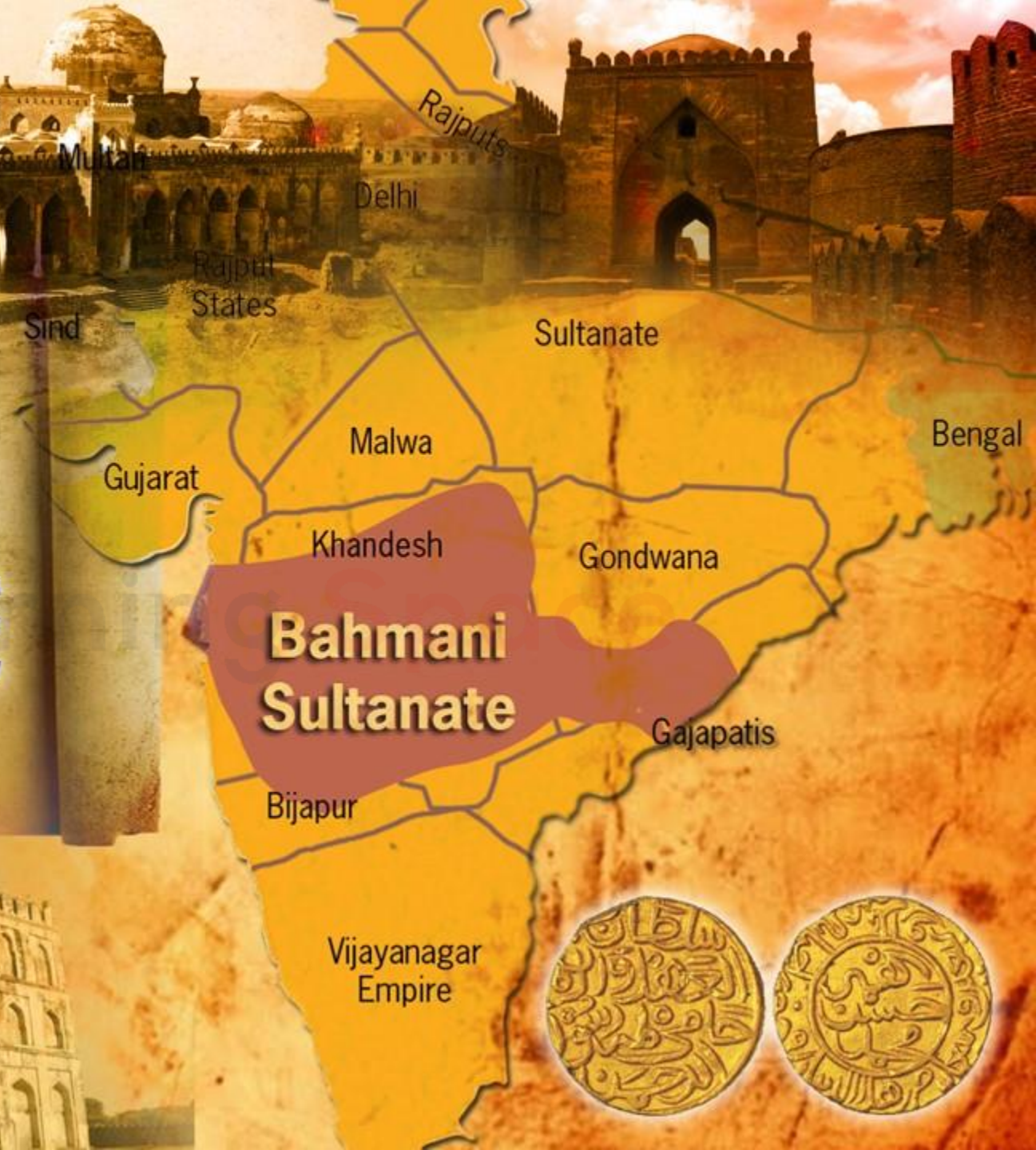


MODULE - 19

**BAHAMANI
SULTANATE**



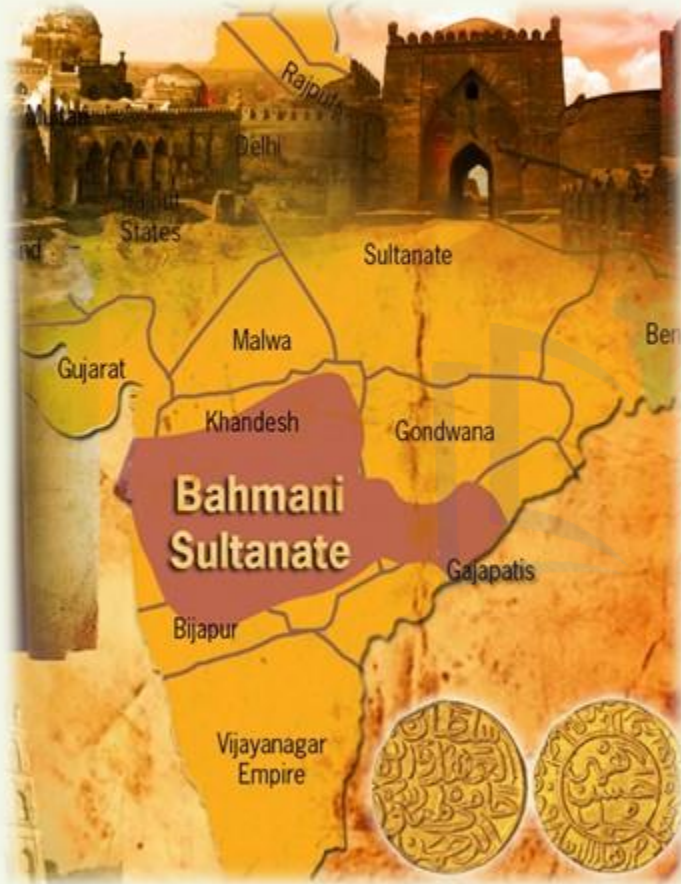
BAHMANI SULTANATE



BAHAMANI SULTANATE

INTRODUCTION

- 1 In the 14th century, along with Vijayanagar kingdom, another powerful kingdom arose in South India, which was the Bahmani Sultanate.
- 2
 - The Deccan region was a part of the provincial administration of the Delhi Sultanate.
 - In order to establish a stable administration in the Deccan, **Mohammad bin Tughlaq** appointed *Amiran-i-sada* also known as Sada Amir (administrative heads of hundred villages).
- 3 From 1337 AD, the conflict between the officers in Deccan and Delhi Sultanate, accelerated which ultimately resulted in the establishment of an independent state in the Deccan in 1347 AD with the capital at **Gulbarga** in Andhra Pradesh.



BAHAMANI KINGDOM

ALAUDDIN HASAN
BAHMAN SHAH
[1347 AD–1358 AD]

TAJ-UD-DIN FIROZ SHAH
[1397 AD–1422 AD]

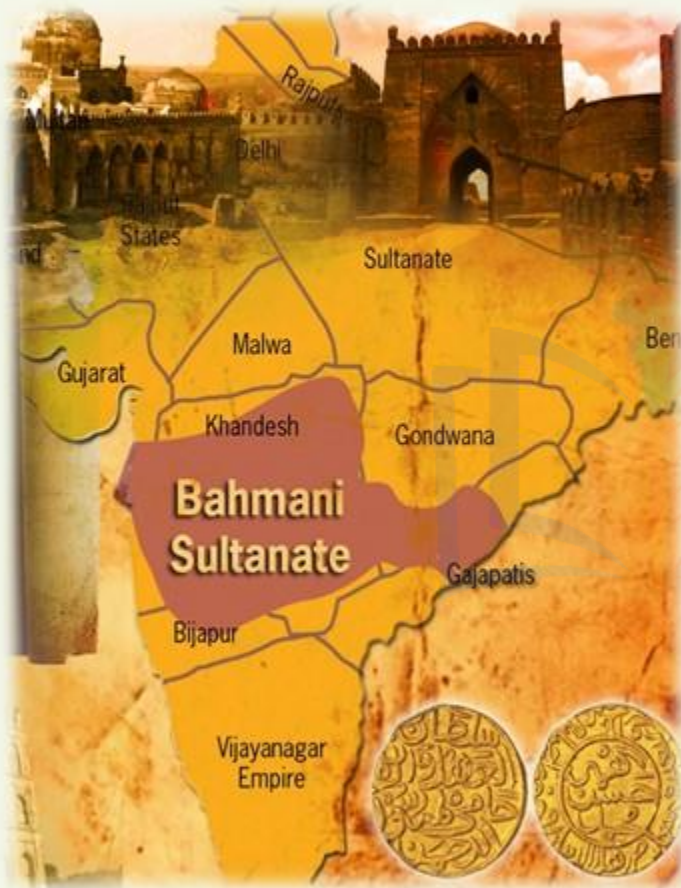
AHMAD SHAH WALI
[1422 AD–1435 AD]

MAHMUD GAWAN
[1461 AD–1481 AD]

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

INTRODUCTION

- 4 Its founder, Hasan Gangu, assumed the title Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah
- 5 Hasan Gangu traced his descent from the mythical hero of Iran, Bahman Shah, and the kingdom was named the Bahmani Sultanate after him.
- 6
 - Since after Mohammad bin Tughlaq, there were no attempts by the Delhi Sultanate to control the Deccan region, therefore, the Bahmani Sultans without any much resistance annexed the other parts of the kingdom too.
 - One of the important acquisitions was the control over Dabhol, an important port on the west coast.



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[1461 AD–1481 AD]

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

INTRODUCTION

ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH (1347-58 AD)



- 1 Founder of the Bahmani Sultanate
- 2 He was an Afghan, who was a General serving under the Sultan Muhammad bin Tughlaq.
- 3 Nazir Uddin Ismail Shah, who had revolted against the Delhi Sultanate, stepped down in favour of Bahman Shah.
- 4 However, according to the historian Ferishta, his original name was Hasan Gangu, as he had earlier served in the service of a brahmana named Gangu and he adopted the word 'Bahman Shah' as a tribute to his brahmana patron.

BAHAMANI KINGDOM

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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

INTRODUCTION

ALAUDDIN HASAN BAHMAN SHAH (1347–58 AD)



- 5 He had regular confrontations with the Vijaynagar kingdom and Warangal state.
- 6 He led his first campaign against Warangal in 1350 AD and forced its ruler to cede to him the fortress of Kaulas.
- 7 By the time of his death, the kingdom stretched from north to south from the Wenganga river to Krishna and east to west from Bhongir to Daulatabad.

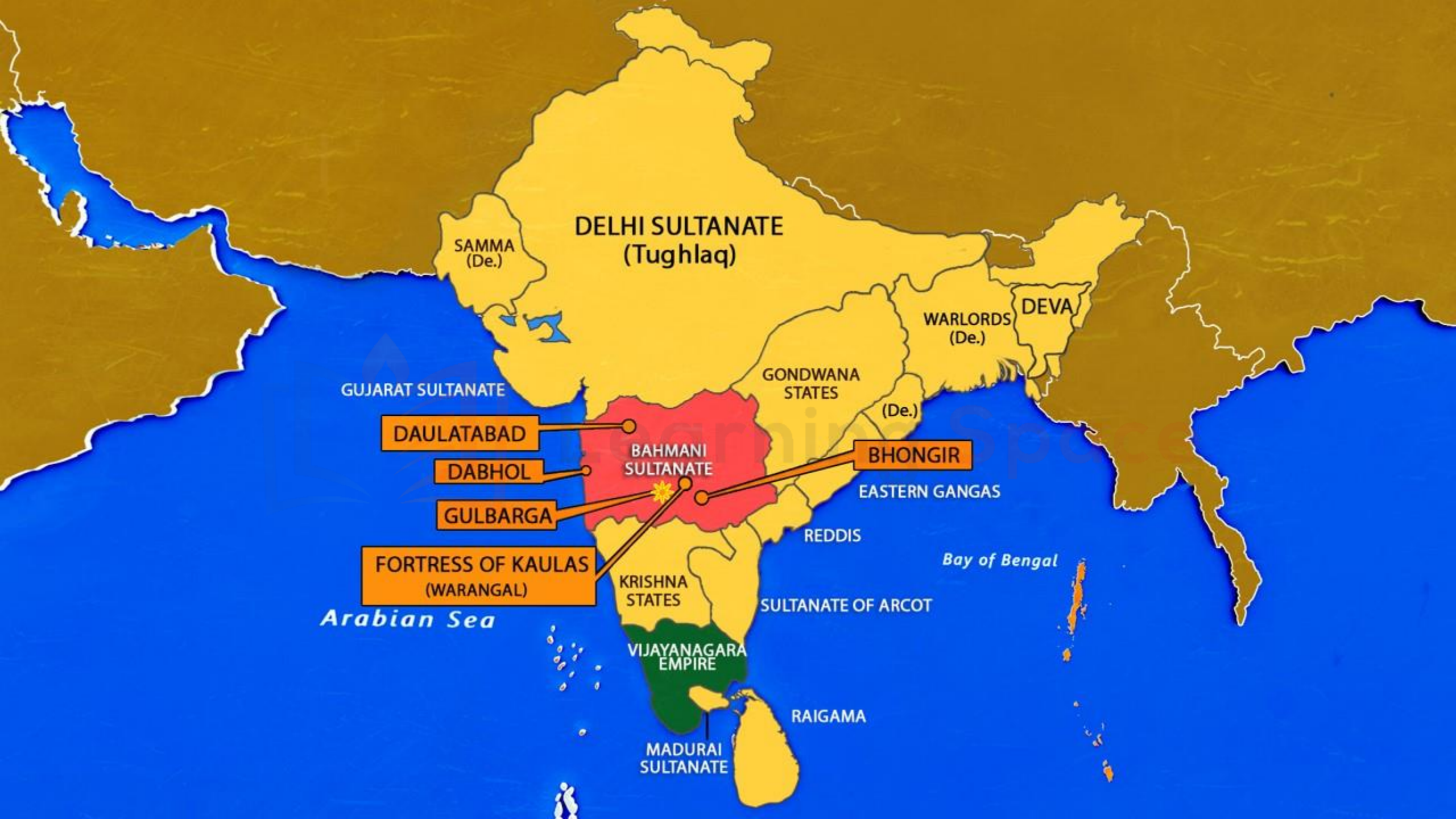
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DELHI SULTANATE
(Tughlaq)

SAMMA
(De.)

WARLORDS
(De.)

DEVA

GONDWANA
STATES

(De.)

GUJARAT SULTANATE

DAULATABAD

DABHOL

GULBARGA

FORTRESS OF KAULAS
(WARANGAL)

BAHMANI
SULTANATE

BHONGIR

EASTERN GANGAS

REDDIS

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

KRISHNA
STATES

SULTANATE OF ARCOT

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

RAIGAMA

MADURAI
SULTANATE

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

TAJ-UD-DIN FIROZ SHAH (1397–1422 AD)



- 1 Considered as the greatest ruler of the dynasty.
- 2
 - He started the Bahmani expansion towards Berar by defeating the Gond Raja Narsing Rai of Kherla.
 - A huge amount of money, gold, and silver was paid to Firuz and a daughter of Rai was married to him.
- 3 Later, he invaded Vijaynagar with back to back victories , but faced a defeat in 1420 AD at the hands of Deva Raya I.
- 4 He was well acquainted with:
 - The religious sciences (commentaries on the Quran, jurisprudence) and
 - Natural sciences (such as botany, geometry, logic, etc.).

BAHAMANI KINGDOM

↓
ALAUDDIN HASAN
BAHMAN SHAH
[1347 AD–1358 AD]

↓
TAJ-UD-DIN FIROZ SHAH
[1397 AD–1422 AD]

↓
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↓
MAHMUD GAWAN
[1461 AD–1481 AD]

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

TAJ-UD-DIN FIROZ SHAH (1397-1422 AD)



- 5 Was a good calligraphist and a poet and often composed extempore verses.
- 6 According to Ferishta, he was well versed not only in Telugu, Kannada, and Marathi but also in Persian, Arabic, and Turkish.
- 7 He encouraged the pursuit of astronomy and built an observatory near Daultabad.
- 8 He had inducted a large number of Hindus in his administration.
- 9 It is said that it was from this time that the *Deccan Brahmins* became dominant in administration.



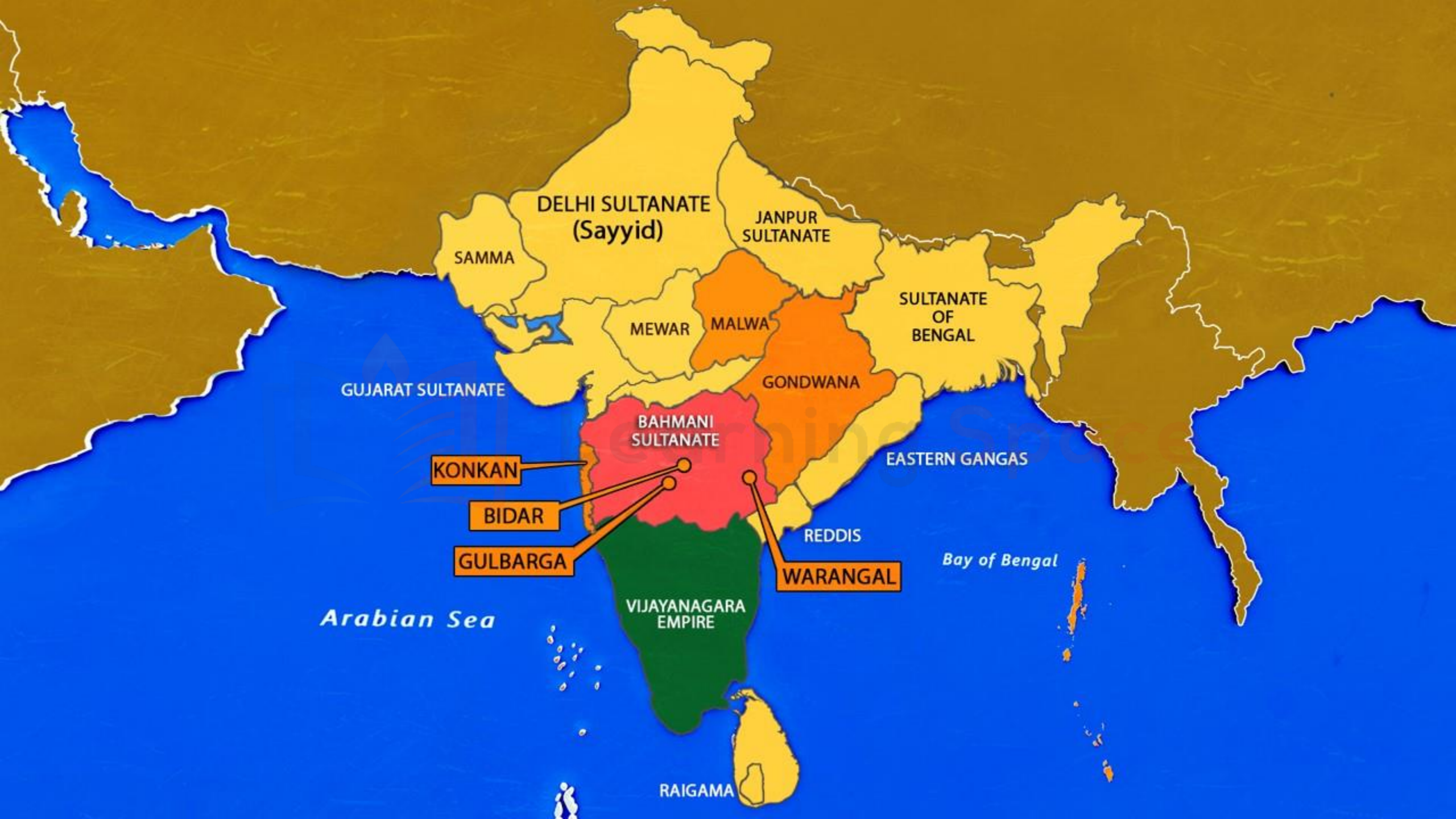
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DELHI SULTANATE
(Sayyid)

JANPUR
SULTANATE

SAMMA

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA

BAHMANI
SULTANATE

EASTERN GANGAS

KONKAN

BIDAR

GULBARGA

REDDIS

WARANGAL

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

RAIGAMA

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

AHMAD SHAH WALI

(1422–35 AD)



- 1 After the defeat of Firuz Shah in 1420 AD, he was forced to abdicate in favour of his brother Ahmad Shah I who is called a saint (wali) on account of his association with the famous Sufi saint *Gesu Daraz*
- 2 He continued the struggle for the domination of the south eastern sea board and in order to punish the ruler of Warangal for siding with the Vijaynagar in the previous battle, he invaded Warangal (1424– 1425 AD), and defeated and killed its ruler and annexed most of its territories.
- 3 After this, he turned his attention toward Malwa, Gondwana, and the Konkan.
- 4 He shifted the capital from Gulbarga to Bidar.

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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

MAHMUD GAWAN

(1461–1481 AD)



- 1 The Bahmani kingdom reached the height of its power and territorial limits under the able guidance of Mahmud Gawan.
- 2 He was a Persian merchant who came to India (Deccan) at the age of 42 years and joined the services of Bahmani kingdom.
- 3 He was granted the title of *Malik-ul-Tujjar*, i.e., 'Chief of the Merchants' by the Bahmani ruler, Humayun Shah.
- 4 The sudden death of Humayun led to the coronation of his minor son Nizam Shah and a regency council was set for the administration of which Mahmud Gawan was an important member.

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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

MAHMUD GAWAN (1461–1481 AD)



- 5 Slowly, due to his personal qualities, he was made wazir (the prime minister) and was given the title of '*Khwaju-i-Jahan.*'
- 6 Gawan carried out many internal administrative reforms and attempted to put an end to the dominance of the nobility and increase the control of Sultan over the nobles and provinces.
- 7 He divided the kingdom into eight tarafs or provinces, each governed by a *tarafdar*.

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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

MAHMUD GAWAN (1461–1481 AD)

- 8
 - In order to curb the military power of the tarafdar, Gawan ordered that only one fort of each province was to be under the direct control of the provincial tarafdar.
 - The remaining forts of the province were placed under a Qiladar or commander of the forts (who was appointed by the central Government).
- 9 Allowances of the nobles were also reduced who shirked their responsibility.
- 10 He was a military genius and waged successful wars against Vijayanagar, Orissa, and the sea pirates on the Arabian sea.

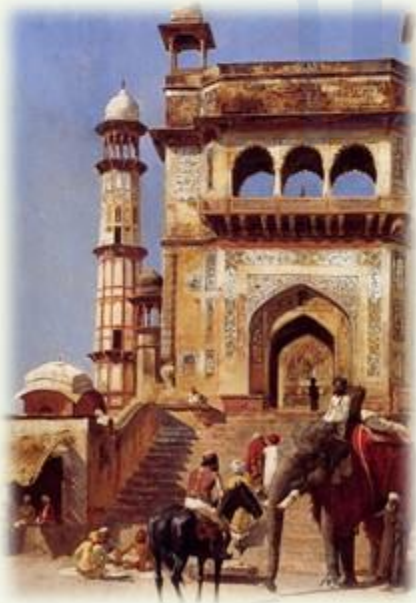
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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

MAHMUD GAWAN (1461–1481 AD)

11 He conquered the Vijayanagar territories up to Kanchi. On the western coast, Goa and Dabhol were conquered. After gaining control over Goa and Dabhol, Bahmani strengthened its trading relations with Iran and Iraq.

12 He introduced the use of gunpowder in the war against the Vijayanagar kings in Belgaum and invited Persian chemists to teach his soldiers the preparation and use of gunpowder.

13 With the help of the ruler of Gujarat, he defeated Mahmud Khalji of Malwa over the control of Berar. Thus, he expanded the Bahmani Empire through his conquests and diplomacy skills.

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DELHI
SULTANATE
(LODHI)

MULTAN

SAMMA

RAJPUT
STATES

(De. occ.)

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

MEWAR

MALWA

GONDWANA
STATES

GUJRAT

GUJARAT SULTANATE

BERAR

GAJAPATI

DABHOL

BELGAUM

GOA

BAHMANI
SULTANATE

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

END OF MAHMUD GAWAN (1461–1481 AD)



**Madarsa of Mahmud Gawan
(Bidar)**

- 1 One of the most difficult problems faced by the Bahmani kingdom was **strife among nobles**.
- 2 The nobles were divided into:
 - ✓ **Deccanis** (oldtimers) and
 - ✓ **Afaqis** (new-comers).
- 3 Despite of being an Afaqi, **Gawan was liberal** and wanted a compromise between the Afaqis and the Deccanis.
- 4 But unfortunately, the petty strife could not be stopped and the **Deccani nobles plotted against Gawan** and induced the young Sultan to punish him with a death sentence and had him executed in 1482 AD.
- 5 Later, the Sultan **regretted his hasty decision** and buried his Prime Minister with honours.

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BAHAMANI SULTANATE

DISINTEGRATION OF BAHAMANI EMPIRE



- 1 After Gawan's execution, the Bahmani kingdom began to disintegrate and the provincial governors declared their independence.
- 2 During this period, the Vijayanagar king Krishna Deva Raya defeated the last remnant of the Bahmani Sultanate's power, after which the Bahmani Sultanate collapsed.
- 3 After 1518 AD, the Sultanate broke up into 5 kingdoms:

BAHAMANI KINGDOM DISINTEGRATION



BAHAMANI SULTANATE

CONFLICT BETWEEN THE VIJAYNAGARA KINGDOM AND BAHMANI SULTANATE

There were constant conflicts between the Vijayanagar kingdom and the Bahmani Sultanate as their interests clashed in three separate and distinct areas:

OVER THE CONTROL OF THE RAICHUR DOAB (BETWEEN RIVERS KRISHNA & TUNGABHADRA)

Reasons

- 1) This area was fertile and rich in mineral resources.
- 2) The famous diamond mines of Golconda were located in the eastern part of the doab region.
- 3) The geography of both the kingdoms was such that expansion was possible only across Tungabhadra in the Deccan.

THE KRISHNA-GODAVARI BASIN

Reasons

- 1) Area was very fertile
- 2) This region had the additional advantage of control of foreign trade (important ports was located here)

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

CONFLICT BETWEEN THE VIJAYNAGARA KINGDOM AND BAHMANI SULTANATE

There were constant conflicts between the Vijayanagar kingdom and the Bahmani Sultanate as their interests clashed in three separate and distinct areas:

OVER THE MARATHWADA REGION(MAIN CONTENTION WAS FOR THE CONTROL OF THE KONKAN BELT):

Reasons

- 1) The Konkan belt was extremely fertile
- 2) It included with it the port of Goa which was an important outlet for export as well as import (especially of horses from Iraq and Iran).

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

ADMINISTRATION



- 1 The Bahmani administrative system was well-organised.
- 2 The Sultanate was initially divided into four administrative units called 'taraf' or provinces.
- 3 These provinces were
 - ✓ Daultabad
 - ✓ Bidar
 - ✓ Berar
 - ✓ Gulbarga.

NOTE: Gawan divided the Sultanate into eight divisions
- 4 Every province was under a tarafdar who was also called a subedar.

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

ADMINISTRATION



- 5 In every province, a tract of land (Khalisa) was set apart from the jurisdiction of the tarafdar as it was used for meeting the expenses of the king and the royal household.
- 6 The salaries and obligations of every noble was fixed.
 - ✓ Those nobles who kept 500 horses were given 10,00,000 coins annually.
 - ✓ If they were short of the stipulated troops, the tarafdar had to reimburse the amount to the central government.
- 7 Nobles used to get their salary either in cash or in form of grant of land or 'jagir'.

BAHAMANI SULTANATE

ADMINISTRATION



- 8 The Bahmanis were familiar with the use of firearms and they employed Turkish and Portuguese experts to train the soldiers in the latest weaponry of warfare.
- 9 Bahmani rulers depended for military support on his Amirs. There were two groups in the ranks of amirs:
 - ✓ One was the Deccanis who were immigrant Muslims and had been staying for a long time in the Deccan region
 - ✓ The Afaqis or Pardesis who had come from Central Asia, Iran, and Iraq, and had settled in the Deccan region recently.
- 10 There was always tension between these groups to appropriate better administrative positions. Because of their internal feuds, the stability of the Bahamani Sultanate was affected.

KEY TERMS TO REMEMBER

KEY TERM	MEANING
Wazir-i-kul	PRIME MINISTER
Amir-i-kul	FINANCE HEAD
Wazir ashraf	FOREIGN AFFAIRS AND ROYAL COURT
Sadar-i-jahan	HEAD OF JUDICIARY AND CHARITIES
Tarafdar	HEAD OF PROVINCE

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